HRMS vendor evaluation checklist

Score each vendor from 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent). Multiply by the weight you give each criterion. Compare totals, then check the notes.

How to use this

Choose 5 to 8 criteria that matter most to your team and set a weight from 1 to 3. Ask every vendor the same questions in the same order. Write down the answers, including what they would not commit to in writing.

Scorecard

Criterion	Weight (1-3)	Vendor A	Vendor B	Vendor C	Notes
Handles our real leave and attendance rules	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Leave flows into attendance without re-entry	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Easy for employees and managers without training	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Pricing published; recurring and one-time costs separate	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Taxes and price changes when we add people are clear	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Setup and data migration plan with named owners	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
We can export all our data in a usable format	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Support: channel, scope and who answers	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Biometric device compatibility confirmed for our devices	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Security and data questions answered in writing	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	
Total (sum of weight x score)					

Questions to ask every vendor

- Which of my processes will I have to change to fit your product?
- What is included in the price, what is extra, and what is one-time?
- What happens to the price if we grow by ten people? By a hundred?
- Who does the setup, and what exactly is included?
- How is our existing employee data brought in?
- Can we export everything, in what format, and at what cost?
- Where is our data hosted, who can access it, and how are backups handled?
- What are the limits of your payroll support, and what depends on other tools?

- Which statutory calculations are covered for our organisation?
- What does support look like, and what is the response commitment for our plan?

Red flags

- Pricing only available after a sales call, with no indication of range.
- Vague answers about data export or what happens if you leave.
- Features shown in the demo that are described as "coming soon" in contracts.
- Pressure to sign before you have tested the product with your own data.

> General template for guidance only. Adapt it to your organisation and to the central and state rules that apply to you, and have it reviewed by a qualified professional before use.

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